

● PRO PLAN · \$19.99/MONTH

ADVANCED PROTOCOL

CARBOHYDRATE CYCLING

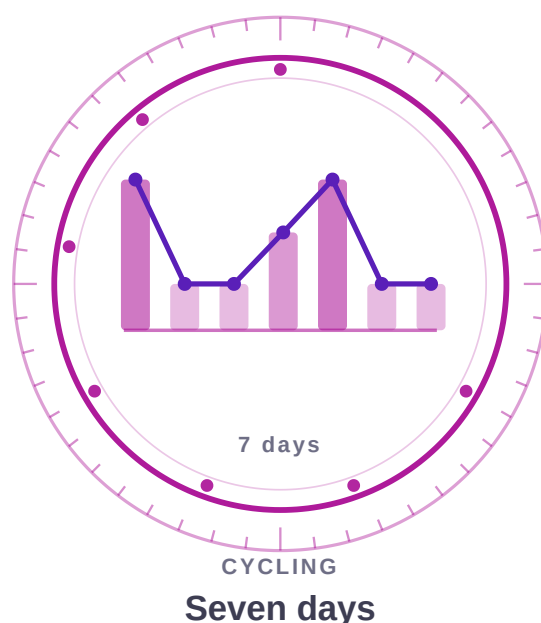
Alternate high, medium and low with your training to improve body composition **without** losing performance.

4 WEEKS

GRAMS PER KG

3 FULL MENUS

REFEEDS



3

DAY TYPES

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WHAT CARBOHYDRATE CYCLING IS

It is a strategy that **alternates carbohydrate intake** with each day's real demand: plenty of fuel when you train hard, little when you rest. No magic and no accelerated metabolism — simply putting the energy where it is needed.

WHO IT DOES WORK FOR

- You have at least 6 months of consistent training
- You already know how to count macros and weigh food
- You want to cut without losing strength on the main lifts
- Your week has clearly different days in terms of intensity

WHO IT IS NOT FOR YET

- You are starting out: master a plain surplus or deficit first
- You do not log what you eat accurately
- You have a history of eating disorders
- Your schedule changes every week and you cannot plan

THE THREE DAY TYPES

DAY TYPE	CARBOHYDRATES	APPROX. CALORIES	WHEN TO USE IT
HIGH · H	300–380 g	2.800–3.100	Heavy training: legs or back
MEDIUM · M	200–250 g	2.400–2.600	Moderate training: upper body
LOW · L	80–120 g	1.900–2.200	Rest or light cardio (LISS)

The table values are for a reference athlete of 75 kg. On page 3 you convert them to **your** body weight.

WHY IT WORKS

- **Insulin sensitivity:** after a hard session, muscle takes up glucose far more efficiently. The high day's carbohydrates go to glycogen, not to fat tissue.
- **Performance protected:** the demanding days arrive with full stores, so you keep your loads while the weekly average stays in deficit.
- **Adherence:** psychologically it is far easier to live with than a flat, monotonous deficit for eight weeks.

WHAT CYCLING DOES NOT DO

It does not burn fat by itself. Fat loss still depends on the **weekly calorie balance**. Cycling merely distributes those calories better so that you perform more and keep muscle while the balance does its work.

CONVERT THE PROTOCOL TO YOUR WEIGHT

Generic figures only serve someone who weighs exactly the same as the reference athlete. These are the protocol's real ratios: multiply them by your kilos and you have your own version.

DAY TYPE	CARBOHYDRATES	PROTEIN	FATS	LOGIC
HIGH	4.5–5.5 g/kg	2.2 g/kg	0.8 g/kg	High carbs, low fat
MEDIUM	3.0–3.5 g/kg	2.4 g/kg	1.0 g/kg	The balance point
LOW	1.0–1.5 g/kg	2.6 g/kg	1.2 g/kg	Fat rises, protein protects the muscle

THE PROTOCOL'S KEY RULE

Protein **rises** when carbohydrates fall, and fats do the opposite of carbs. That way calories do not collapse on low days and you protect muscle mass exactly when the risk of losing it is highest.

WORKED EXAMPLE · 75 KG ATHLETE

DAY	CARBS	PROTEIN	FATS	CALORIES
High (5.0 g/kg)	375 g	165 g	60 g	2.700
Medium (3.2 g/kg)	240 g	180 g	75 g	2.355
Low (1.3 g/kg)	98 g	195 g	90 g	1.982
Weekly average (3 H · 2 M · 2 L)	243 g	177 g	73 g	2,386 kcal

YOUR TABLE — WORK IT OUT ONCE AND USE IT FOR 4 WEEKS

DAY	CARBS (G/KG × _____ KG)	PROTEIN	FATS	CALORIES
High	_____	_____	_____	_____
Medium	_____	_____	_____	_____
Low	_____	_____	_____	_____

Remember: 1 g of carbohydrate = 4 kcal · 1 g of protein = 4 kcal · 1 g of fat = 9 kcal. Fibre is already included in the carbohydrate count.

4-WEEK CALENDAR

WEEK	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Week 1	A	M	A	B	A	M	B
Week 2	A	B	A	M	A	B	B
Week 3	M	A	B	A	M	A	B
Week 4	A	M	A	B	A	A	M

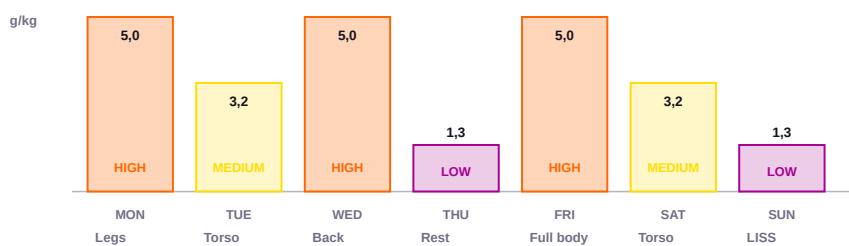
ADAPT THE PATTERN TO YOUR WEEK, NOT THE OTHER WAY ROUND

This calendar assumes heavy training on Monday, Wednesday and Friday. If your leg day is Tuesday, move the HIGH day to Tuesday. The rule that never changes is: **high day = day of greatest training volume**.

HOW TO PAIR EACH DAY WITH YOUR TRAINING

YOUR SESSION	DAY TYPE	HOW THE CARBOHYDRATES ARE SPLIT
Heavy legs or back	HIGH	50 % before training · 30 % after · 20 % rest of the day
Chest, shoulders or arms	MEDIUM	40 % before · 30 % after · 30 % rest
Full body or hybrid	HIGH	45 % before · 35 % after · 20 % rest
LISS cardio or mobility	LOW	Split as you like, prioritise vegetables and protein
Full rest	LOW	Split as you like, a fattier dinner for satiety

FIG. 1 THE CYCLING WEEK AT A GLANCE



The rule that does not change: the high day goes where the training volume is highest. The weekly average still lands in deficit even

Each bar's height = grams of carbohydrate per kilo of body weight. Compare this figure with the table on the previous page before setting your own week.

HIGH-CARBOHYDRATE DAY

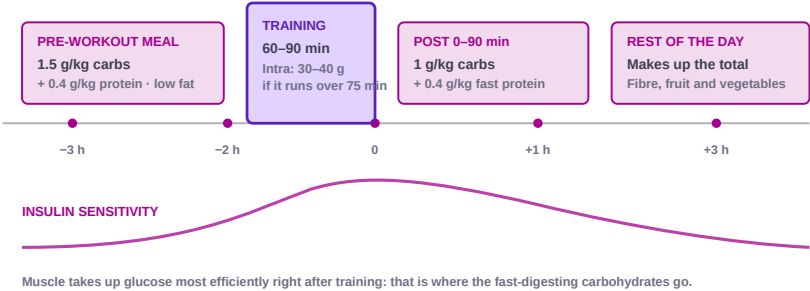
366 g	205 g	62 g	2.850
CARBOHYDRATES	PROTEIN	FATS	KCAL

MEAL	FOODS	CARBS	PROT.	KCAL
Breakfast	Oats 100 g + banana + 3 egg whites	85 g	28 g	520
Pre-workout	Cooked rice 200 g + chicken 200 g + tomato	92 g	48 g	680
Post-workout	Protein shake + rice pudding 100 g	55 g	42 g	450
Lunch	Pasta 150 g + salmon 180 g + salad	88 g	45 g	720
Dinner	Sweet potato 200 g + chicken breast 180 g + vegetables	46 g	42 g	480
Day total	—	366 g	205 g	2.850

HIGH-DAY TIMING

WINDOW	TARGET	PRACTICAL DETAIL
2 h before	Fill the stores	The day's biggest carbohydrate meal, low in fat so it digests fast
Intra-workout	Hold the intensity	Only if the session runs over 75 min: 30–40 g of liquid carbohydrate
0–90 min after	Replenish glycogen	Fast-digesting carbohydrate + 40 g of protein
Rest of the day	Make up the total	Wholegrain sources, fruit and vegetables to reach fibre and micronutrients

FIG. 2 THE HIGH DAY'S PERI-WORKOUT WINDOW



The grams are in g/kg of body weight, so they scale by themselves. The lower curve is the reason for the whole protocol.

DROP THE FAT WHEN THE CARBS GO UP

The high day is not a day for eating more of everything. Fats drop to 0.8 g/kg precisely to make caloric room for the carbohydrates. If you keep fat high and raise carbs as well, you have created a surplus by accident.

MEDIUM-CARBOHYDRATE DAY

240 g

CARBOHYDRATES

202 g

PROTEIN

76 g

FATS

2.500

KCAL

MEAL	FOODS	CARBS	PROT.	KCAL
Breakfast	Oats 60 g + 2 eggs + 2 egg whites + blueberries	40 g	26 g	420
Pre-workout	Rice 120 g dry + chicken 180 g + sautéed vegetables	92 g	44 g	660
Post-workout	Protein shake + large banana	30 g	27 g	250
Lunch	Sweet potato 200 g + salmon 150 g + green salad	40 g	35 g	490
Dinner	Chicken breast 180 g + quinoa 40 g + broccoli + 1 tbsp of olive oil	30 g	44 g	430
Before bed	Cottage cheese 200 g + walnuts 15 g	8 g	26 g	250
Day total	—	240 g	202 g	2.500

Menu calculated for a 75 kg athlete. Scale the amounts in proportion to your weight using the table on page 3.

THE MEDIUM DAY IS THE MOST USEFUL OF THE THREE

- It is your **default day**: when in doubt about which type of day it is, choose medium.
- It fits 70 % of real sessions: upper body, technique or moderate volume.
- It lets you train well without piling up the fatigue of repeated low days.
- It is the day you will use to **maintain** once the protocol is over.

VALID SWAPS FOR THE MEDIUM DAY

Sweet potato ↔ potato ↔ brown rice · Salmon ↔ mackerel ↔ fresh tuna · Cottage cheese ↔ 0 % Greek yoghurt ↔ casein · Quinoa ↔ wholewheat couscous ↔ bulgur. Keep the grams of carbohydrate, not the weight of the food.

LOW-CARBOHYDRATE DAY

75 g CARBOHYDRATES	219 g PROTEIN	92 g FATS	2.160 KCAL
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MEAL	FOODS	CARBS	PROT.	KCAL
Breakfast	Omelette of 4 egg whites + 2 eggs + avocado	6 g	36 g	380
Snack 1	Greek yoghurt + nuts	12 g	22 g	280
Lunch	Salmon 220 g + large salad + olive oil	18 g	48 g	520
Snack 2	Whey protein + almonds 30 g	10 g	35 g	340
Dinner	Chicken breast 200 g + broccoli + spinach	15 g	50 g	380
Before bed	Cottage cheese 200 g + chia seeds	14 g	28 g	260
Day total	—	75 g	219 g	2.160

HOW TO GET THROUGH A LOW DAY WELL

PROBLEM	CAUSE	SOLUTION
Mid-afternoon hunger	Too little food volume	Double the vegetables: they add satiety at almost no calorie cost
Headache	Lack of sodium and water	Add salt to your meals and add 500 ml of water
Strong sugar craving	Glucose dip and habit	Sugar-free jelly, herbal tea or 20 g of 90 % chocolate
Feeling flat in the gym	You have put the low day next to a hard session	Reorder the week: the low day belongs with rest or easy cardio
Constipation	Less fibre when cereals go down	Leafy greens, chia, psyllium and 2.5 L of water

NEVER CHAIN MORE THAN TWO LOW DAYS IN A ROW

Three or more consecutive low days sink performance, sleep quality and mood, and send the odds of a binge through the roof. If the calendar forces it, turn the third into a medium day.

WHERE EVERY NUMBER COMES FROM

Every number in this document comes from sources that are public, free and checkable. Not one figure is invented, rounded for convenience or copied from another popular publication. This page exists so that you can verify it yourself.

WHY THESE SOURCES AND NO OTHERS

Works of the United States federal government are not subject to copyright (17 U.S.C. § 105). That makes a handful of agencies the only source of nutrition and training data that is both first-rate and legally free. This is not restricted material: it is public material that almost nobody opens.

WHAT YOU ARE LOOKING FOR	WHAT YOU WILL FIND	WHERE
Reference intakes	RDA, AI and tolerable upper intake level for every vitamin and mineral	ods.od.nih.gov
Food composition	The full profile of any food, nutrient by nutrient	fdc.nal.usda.gov
Dietary guidelines	Dietary patterns and limits for added sugars, saturated fat and sodium	health.gov
Physical activity guidelines	The weekly dose, its response curve and the strength requirement	health.gov
Physical readiness doctrine	FM 7-22: training, nutrition, sleep and mental readiness	armypubs.army.mil
Lifting equation	How much weight is reasonable to lift in each specific situation	cdc.gov/niosh
Food safety	Safe internal temperatures and the danger zone	foodsafety.gov
Health claims	What may legally be claimed about a nutrient in Europe, and what was refused	European Commission register

HOW THIS DOCUMENT CHECKS ITSELF

The reference figures are not typed by hand: they live in a data module that the typesetting program verifies before writing a single line. It checks that the macronutrient ranges can add up to one hundred per cent of energy, that none of the 19 micronutrients has a recommended value above its own ceiling without a note explaining why, and that no safe cooking temperature falls inside the danger zone. If a single check fails, the document is not typeset.

REFERENCE VALUES ARE POPULATION VALUES

They describe what covers the needs of most healthy adults. They are not an individual prescription, they do not account for disease, pregnancy, breastfeeding or medication, and no publication replaces assessment by a registered health professional. If you take medication, some of the nutrients named here interact with it in clinically relevant ways: do not change an intake or start a supplement without telling whoever prescribes for you.

REFEEDS, ADJUSTMENTS AND SIGNALS

WHEN AND HOW TO RUN A REFEED

SIGNAL	WHAT IT INDICATES	ACTION
Weight flat for 2 weeks and strength falling	Empty stores, not a missing deficit	One extra high day at 6 g/kg of carbohydrate
Weight dropping more than 1 % a week	Deficit too aggressive	Turn a low day into a medium one
Weight up two weeks in a row	No real deficit	Turn a high day into a medium one
Poor sleep and high resting pulse	Accumulated fatigue	A full week at medium level before resuming

4-WEEK LOG

WEEK	AVERAGE WEIGHT	WAIST	STRENGTH (FEEL 1-10)	ADJUSTMENT APPLIED
Week 1				
Week 2				
Week 3				
Week 4				

CYCLING IS TUNED WITH DATA, NOT FAITH

Give the protocol **three full weeks** before you touch anything, then change it with the scale and the log in front of you. A cycling plan corrected every few days is not a cycling plan: it is noise.

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